

SAMPLE ITINERARY

A sample 6-day Kunming, Dali and Lijiang journey.

Six days, five nights. A private vehicle between the stops, and the morning trains between Kunming and Dali.

01 **Kunming**
Airport pickup, then a free afternoon.

02 **Dali**
Morning train, then the lake.

03 **Dali to Lijiang**
The old town, then the drive north.

04 **Lijiang**
Shuhe, the snow mountain, Blue Moon Valley.

05 **Kunming**
The lake and the flower market.

06 **Departure**
Transfer to the airport or the station.

This is an example of a real route, so you can see how a journey is written down. Your own trip is shaped around your dates, pace and interests. It is not a booking, and it is not the final proposal.

DAY 1 · KUNMING

Arrive in Kunming.

Airport pickup · Stay in Kunming · Meals on your own

A driver meets you at Kunming Changshui International Airport (昆明长水国际机场) and takes you to the hotel. The driver confirms the pickup by message or phone the day before the flight. The rest of the day is free.

IF YOU HAVE THE ENERGY

- Green Lake Park (翠湖公园)
- Guandu Old Town (官渡古镇)
- Yunnan Provincial Museum (云南省博物馆)
- Kunming Old Street (昆明老街) or Park 1903

Crossing-the-bridge rice noodles, steam-pot chicken and flower cakes are the local things to try.

BEFORE YOU LAND

Kunming sits higher than most coastal cities. Daytime sun is strong from spring through autumn, and nights can be cool. Pack layers, SPF 50, a hat and sunglasses.

Some people feel the altitude for a day or two. Keep the driver and hotel numbers with you.

USUALLY a 3-star hotel, or another of the same standard if that one is full. 宜尚 · 旺马假日 · 蒂罗兰艺潮 · 君遨 · 云居 · Eden · 维也纳科技园 · 兰翔序

ON REQUEST 4-star and 5-star hotels, including Wyndham properties.

DAY 2 · DALI

Morning train to Dali, then the lake.

High-speed train · Stay in Dali · Breakfast included, other meals on your own



Erhai Lake (洱海), Dali.

After breakfast you take an early train to Dali. Departures are usually between 07:34 and 08:30. The exact train is assigned by the booking system and cannot be chosen in advance.

The day is built around Erhai Lake. Ideal Garden (理想花园) includes one gift for the group: either 5–6 electronic garden photos for the family, without styling or retouching, or afternoon tea in the garden. From there you continue to Santorini · Ideal State (圣托里尼 · 理想邦), the blue-and-white hillside on the eastern shore.

You then choose one of two stops, because they sit in different directions. Tell the operator before the trip. Xingsheng Bridge (兴盛大桥) crosses the Xi'er River. Cang'er Avenue (苍洱大道) is the open road between Cangshan Mountain and the lake, and it works well for a walk or a short ride.

Dali is about 1,970 metres. The garden is full of flowers. If you take the photos, light, plain clothes photograph well, and you can do your own makeup beforehand.

USUALLY a 3-star hotel, or similar. 潮漫 · 柏雅 · 季枫国际 · 林恋 · 漫程 · 漫咖

ON REQUEST 大理和庄 · 景岸逸林 · 美仑 · 漫悦 M 花园 · 悦云雅阁 · 五彩云 · 维笙山海湾 · Four Points · 红龙井

DAY 3 · DALI TO LIJIANG

Dali Old Town, then on to Lijiang.

Private vehicle · Stay in Lijiang · Breakfast included, other meals on your own



Dali Old Town (大理古城).

After breakfast you go to Dali Old Town, the walled town between Erhai and Cangshan, laid out in the Ming dynasty. Four experiences are included:

- A sightseeing ride in a music-bar vehicle, with a drink and snacks.
- Three electronic photos per person, plus one 30-second drone video for the group.
- A short Bai dance led by a local dancer, a Jinhua (金花).
- A bicycle ride along the Taoyuan S-bend (桃源 S 湾) beside the lake.

In Zhoucheng (周城), a Bai village known for tie-dye, you try the indigo cloth yourself. The vehicle then continues to Lijiang for the night.

USUALLY a 3-star hotel, or similar. 梵悦云栖 · 静宁祉悠 · 丽雅如金 · 丽呈睿轩 · 雪壳假日 · 艺龙海岚 · 家四季

ON REQUEST 岚玥花间 · 大恒别苑 · 右见雪山 · 玉龙温德姆 Wyndham · 复华丽朗 · 悦云别院 · 丽江国际

DAY 4 · LIJIANG

Shuhe, the snow mountain and Blue Moon Valley.

Private vehicle · Stay in Lijiang · Breakfast included, other meals on your own



Shuhe Old Town (束河古镇).



Blue Moon Valley (蓝月谷).

The morning starts in Shuhe Old Town, a quieter Tea Horse Road town of the Naxi people, with streams running past the lanes. You then go to Jade Dragon Snow Mountain (玉龙雪山). The main peak, Shanzidou (扇子陡), is 5,596 metres.

Spruce Meadow (云杉坪) is reached by the smaller cable car. The ride climbs from forest to meadow. A boardwalk continues into the trees. The glacier cable car is a separate, higher ride. Older guests, young children, and anyone with a heart, blood-pressure or breathing condition should skip that higher car and stay with the lower one. If a cable car stops, the operator changes to another car or refunds it on the spot.

Blue Moon Valley sits under the mountain. The valley tram is about 60 RMB per person and is not included. The day also includes a ranch portrait for each person: makeup, one outfit from what is available that day, and three retouched electronic photos.

STAY a second night in Lijiang, at the same range of hotels as Day 3.

DAY 5 · KUNMING

Back to Kunming, by the lake and the flower market.

Morning train · Stay in Kunming · Breakfast included, other meals on your own

An early train returns to Kunming, about three hours. Check the train time the night before and keep a light jacket for the morning.

At Dianchi Lake (滇池) you walk Haigeng Dam (海埂大坝), with the water on one side and the Western Hills on the other. In winter, black-headed gulls from Siberia gather here. Haihong Wetland Park (海洪湿地公园) is close by, a stand of dawn redwood and boardwalks. Rowing boats and glass boats there are optional and paid on the spot.

Dounan Flower Market (斗南花市) is the last stop, a wholesale market of roses, sunflowers, lisianthus, hydrangea and lilies. You can buy a bunch or have it packed and posted. Fresh flowers may not be allowed on a plane or a train, so posting is the simpler way. The hotel is in Kunming. Nanping Street or Shuangqiao Night Market are easy if you want one more bowl of rice noodles.

STAY Kunming, in the same hotel range as Day 1.

DAY 6 · DEPARTURE

A transfer to the airport or the station.

Private transfer · No hotel tonight · Breakfast included

After checkout, a car takes you to Kunming Changshui International Airport, Kunming Station or Kunming South Station, timed to your flight or train. For a flight, arrive at the airport about two hours ahead. For a high-speed train, about 40 minutes is enough.

Check the flower rules again if you are carrying stems onto a plane. Look through the room for passports and chargers before you leave.

What’s included, and what is not.

INCLUDED

- Entrance tickets for the places named in the route. Small transport inside a scenic area is extra.
- Five nights, usually in a selected 3-star hotel. A same-standard hotel is used if the named one cannot take the group.
- A vehicle with one seat per person.
- Hotel breakfast. If you skip it, the cost is not refunded. Lunch and dinner are not included.
- A driver who also guides the route. The order of stops can change for traffic or weather. A listed stop is not dropped.
- A Yunnan travel safety insurance package.

NOT INCLUDED

- Personal accident insurance and flight insurance. Buying your own is sensible.
- The single-room supplement, if you want a room to yourself.
- Hotel extras: laundry, calls, paid television, drinks.
- Extra costs from a delayed or cancelled flight, or from weather and other events outside the operator’s control.
- Transport and meals during free time.
- Costs caused by a guest’s own change of plan, or by an existing or sudden illness.
- Children’s costs that are not already in the quote. Parents pay those on the spot.

Tickets are bought by the operator as a set. A senior, student or other discount card cannot be applied again, and the ticket is not refunded if you do not use it. Concession prices at the gate are separate from this arrangement.

Good to know.

- Driving times are a guide in clear traffic. They do not include time at each stop.
- If a storm, a road closure or an official order changes the day, the operator adjusts the plan. Extra costs from that change are paid by the guest.
- Shops at hotels, restaurants and scenic stops sell local goods, from tea and fruit to jade and silver. Buying is your own choice. Ask for a receipt, and avoid goods with no maker and no label. The operator is not part of that purchase.
- On arrival, check the room and report anything damaged before you settle in. Keep passports, cash and medicine with you.
- Jade Dragon Snow Mountain is high. Guests with heart, blood-pressure or breathing conditions, and older guests or young children, should use the lower cable car rather than the glacier car.
- If something is wrong, say so that day to the driver-guide. The local operator records comments on its trip form before you leave.